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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Background

1.1.1 The development of the Loop was one of the ten major infrastructure projects for economic growth in Hong Kong announced in the 2007-08 Policy Address. In March 2008, the "Hong Kong-Shenzhen Joint Task Force on Boundary District Development" under the "Hong Kong/Shenzhen Co-operation Meeting" agreed to conduct a joint comprehensive study on the development of the Loop. A Planning and Engineering Study jointly undertaken by the HKSAR Government and Shenzhen Municipal People's Government (SZMG) commenced in 2009 and completed in 2013.

1.1.2 In January 2017, the "Memorandum of Understanding on Jointly Developing the Lok Ma Chau Loop by Hong Kong and Shenzhen" (the MOU) was signed by the HKSAR Government and the SZMG, agreeing to jointly develop the Loop as the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Innovation and Technology Park (the Park), setting up a key base for scientific research, as well as relevant higher education, cultural and creative industries and other complementary facilities.

1.1.3 According to the MOU, the HKSAR Government is responsible for the construction of the infrastructure within the Loop (including site formation and infrastructural facilities) and the provision of supporting infrastructural facilities outside the Loop which are necessary to the development of the Loop and its surrounding areas. The Park will be developed in two phases. On 8 January 2021, the Finance Committee of the Legislative Council approved funding for Public Works Programme Item No. 7856CL "Development of the Loop – Main Works Package 1 (MWP1) – site formation and infrastructure works". The site formation and construction of infrastructure works under MWP1 commenced in July 2021. The first batch of land parcels for building works of the Park was handed over to the Hong Kong Shenzhen Innovation and Technology Park Limited (HSITPL) in December 2021.

1.1.4 MWP1 covered the site formation and infrastructure works for substantial part of the Loop, including site formation for the entire Park, major carriageways/footpaths/cycle tracks within the Park and those connecting to the areas on the west and southwest, etc. The project of Development of the Loop – Main Works Package 2 is needed for the provision of the remaining infrastructure and facilities to support Phase 2 development of the Park and strengthening the external transport link of the Park.

1.1.5 The Central Government promulgated in August 2023 the "Development Plan for Shenzhen Park of Hetao Shenzhen-Hong Kong Science and Technology Innovation Co-operation Zone", setting out the development positioning of the Shenzhen Park. The Chief Executive has set out in the 2023 Policy Address that the HKSAR Government will render its full support and work with the Shenzhen Municipal Government to foster the synergistic development of the Hong Kong Park (i.e. the Park hereinbefore) and the Shenzhen Park. The Hong Kong Park will be developed in two phases from west to east. The preliminary planning for its first phase has been completed. The HSITPL will commence relevant planning works of the Phase 2 development.

1.1.6 To strengthen the external transport links of the Loop, it is proposed to construct a link road between the eastern part of the Loop and the Kwu Tung North New Development Area (KTN NDA) via the Ma Tso Lung area. The Project is also considered necessary for supporting Phase 2 development of the Loop from traffic point of view.

1.1.7 In 2023, AECOM Asia Company Limited (AECOM) was commissioned by Civil Engineering and Development Department (CEDD) to undertake the assignment of Agreement No. CE35/2023 (HY) Development of the Loop: Eastern Connection Road – Investigation, Design and Construction (hereafter called "the Project").

1.2 Designated Projects under Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance

1.2.1 A Project Profile (No. PP-661/2024) was submitted to Environmental Protection Department (EPD) on 14 February 2024 for application for an Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) Study Brief under section 5(7)(a) of the Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance (EIAO) and EIA Study Brief No. ESB-364/2024 for the Project was issued on 28 March 2024 under the EIAO.

1.2.2 Subsequent to the issue of the EIA Study Brief (No. ESB-364/2024) in March 2024, some changes were made to the project boundary, layout and design to facilitate the project development. In accordance with Clause 6.2 of the EIA Study Brief, it was checked if there was any key change in the scope of the Project mentioned in Section 1.2 and 1.3 of the Study Brief and in the Project Profile (No. PP-661/2024), confirmation would have to be sought from the Direction of Environmental Protection in writing on whether or not the scope of issues covered by the EIA Study Brief can still cover the key changes, and the additional issues, if any, that the EIA report must address. Considering the latest development of the interface project, alignment of ECR was adjusted / extended accordingly. As a result, the EIA Study Brief (No. ESB-364/2024) needs to be adjusted. A Project Profile (No. PP-685/2025) and further information was submitted to EPD on 14 May and 9 June 2025 for application for a fresh EIA Study Brief, and the fresh EIA Study Brief No. ESB-375/2025 was issued on 21 July 2025 under the EIAO. The location plan of the Project is shown in **60722948/A10/FIGURE 1.1**.

1.2.3 The Project comprises the following elements which are classified as Designated Projects (DPs) under Part I, Schedule 2 of the EIAO. The DPs elements of this Project is summarized in **Table 1.1**.

Table 1.1 Schedule 2 Designated Projects in this Project

Schedule 2 Designated Project		Designated Project Element under this Project
Item A.9	A carriageway for motor vehicles fully enclosed by decking above and by structure on the sides for more than 100 m.	The road sections under this Project comprises of construction of an underpass carriageway of about 800m.
Item I.1	A drainage channel or river training and diversion works located less than 300 m from the nearest boundary of an existing or planned conservation area.	The construction of underpass will require 50% flow contraction by cofferdams. Treated runoff or diverted runoff will be discharged to the Meander (i.e. the old Shenzhen river section) which is less than 300m from the nearest boundary of the "Conservation Area" under the Approved Lok Ma Chau Loop OZP No. S/LMCL/2, Approved Ma Tso Lung and Hoo Hok Wai OZP No. S/NE-MTL/3 and

Schedule 2 Designated Project		Designated Project Element under this Project
		Approved San Tin Technopole OZP No. S/STT/2.
Item Q.1	Earthworks, dredging works and other building works partly or wholly in an existing conservation area	The part of the alignment under this Project, involving earthworks for the construction of the ECR (e.g. earthworks for construction of underpass and formation of slopes), will be within the "Conservation Area" under the Approved Lok Ma Chau Loop OZP No. S/LMCL/2, Approved Ma Tso Lung and Hoo Hok Wai OZP No. S/NE-MTL/3 and Approved San Tin Technopole OZP No. S/STT/2.

1.3 Purpose of the EIA Study

1.3.1 The purpose of the EIA Study is to provide information on the nature and extent of environmental impacts arising from the construction and operation of the Project and associated works that will take place concurrently. This information will contribute to decisions by the Director of Environmental Protection:-

- the overall acceptability of any adverse environmental consequences that are likely to arise as a result of the Project;
- the conditions and requirements for the detailed design, construction and operation of the Project to mitigate against adverse environmental consequences wherever practicable; and
- the acceptability of residual impacts after the proposed mitigation measures are implemented.

1.4 Objectives of the EIA Study

1.4.1 The objectives of the EIA study as per Section 2 of the EIA Study Brief are as follows:-

(i) to describe the Project and associated works together with the requirements and environmental benefits for carrying out the Project;

(ii) to identify and describe the elements of the community and environment likely to be affected by the Project, and/or likely to cause adverse impacts to the Project, including both the natural and man made environment and the associated environmental constraints;

(iii) to identify and quantify emission sources and determine the significance of impacts on sensitive receivers and potential affected uses;

(iv) to identify and quantify any potential losses or damage to flora, fauna and natural habitats;

(v) to identify any negative impacts on sites of cultural heritage and to propose measures to mitigate these impacts;

(vi) to propose the provision of infrastructure or mitigation measures to minimize pollution, environmental disturbance and nuisance during construction and operation of the Project;

(vii) to investigate the feasibility, effectiveness and implications of the proposed mitigation measures;

(viii) to identify, predict and evaluate the residual (i.e. after practicable mitigation) environmental impacts and the cumulative effects expected to arise during the construction and operation phases of the Project in relation to the sensitive receivers and potential affected uses;

(ix) to identify, assess and specify methods, measures and standards, to be included in the detailed design, construction and operation of the Project which are necessary to mitigate these residual environmental impacts and cumulative effects and reduce them to acceptable levels; and

(x) to design and specify the environmental monitoring and audit requirements.

1.5 Structure of this Report

1.5.1 The background of the Project, purpose and objectives of this Report are introduced in this section. A description of the Project is provided in **Section 2**. **Sections 3** to **11** detail the assessment of each key environmental issues covering relevant legislation, assessment criteria, baseline environmental conditions, methodology and assessment findings.

1.5.2 **Sections 3** to **11** are outlined as below:

- **Section 3 –** Air Quality Impact;
- **Section 4 –** Noise Impact;
- **Section 5 –** Water Quality Impact;
- **Section 6 –** Waste Management Implication;
- **Section 7 –** Land Contamination;
- **Section 8 –** Ecological Impact;
- **Section 9 –** Fisheries Impact;
- **Section 10 –** Landscape and Visual Impact; and
- **Section 11 –** Impact to Cultural Heritage

1.5.3 As outline of the requirements for Environmental Monitoring and Audit (EM&A) programme is presented in **Section 12**. The EM&A programme is presented in detailed in a separate EM&A Manual. A summary of environmental outcomes is provided in **Section 13** and conclusion of the whole assessment is presented in **Section 14**.

1.5.4 An Executive Summary has been prepared as a separate document in both Chinese and English, which contains summaries of the key findings, recommendations and conclusions of the EIA Report.